

ISO 9001:2015 · AUDIT PREPARATION COMPANION

# Audit Preparation Companion

## Example Ltd

Building services contractor based in Coventry, West Midlands, specialising in the installation and maintenance of heating, ventilation, and electrical systems for commercial clients including schools, NHS sites, and offices.

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|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Locale       | en-GB                                               |
| Prepared for | Gareth Pryce                                        |
| Companion to | Quality Management System Manual · Example Ltd v1.0 |

This document helps Example Ltd prepare for ISO 9001:2015 Stage 1 and Stage 2 audits in the UK context, tailored to the company's people, procedures, and quality objectives. It provides audit-ready, company-specific questions, the types of evidence an auditor will expect, applicable timescales, and a roadmap based on your actual processes for heating, ventilation and electrical installation projects.

## Context of the Organisation

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### AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Explain how Example Ltd identifies and tracks the regulatory requirements relevant to electrical and mechanical installations, such as BS 7671, Gas Safe registration, and CDM regulations on your active projects.
- ☐ Show how you determine and update your understanding of interested parties (e.g., main contractors, NHS, schools, suppliers) and their expectations for quality and delivery in your sector.
- ☐ Your manual details risks such as late material deliveries and incomplete certification — how are these risks recorded, regularly reviewed, and mitigated in practice at Example Ltd?
- ☐ Describe how you ensure that organisational knowledge (especially process know-how held by long-term staff) is captured and transferred, not just managed informally.

### EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Copy of current regulations referenced in your processes (BS 7671, Gas Safe, CDM) and examples of how these are communicated in RAMS and site briefings.
- ☐ Matrix or table of interested parties (customers, suppliers, regulators, staff) showing their key expectations and reference to examples in meeting minutes or project planning.
- ☐ Documented risk register/list with named owners for each risk (e.g., material delays, incomplete certification, ticket expiry), including mitigation actions and how these are reviewed (date, signature).
- ☐ Notes or materials from team meetings, toolbox talks, or onboarding records that demonstrate deliberate transfer of company-specific know-how.

### **TIMING & FREQUENCY**

- ☐ Risk registers and interested parties tables should be current (reviewed within the last 12 months).
- ☐ Evidence of knowledge transfer (toolbox talks, onboarding) should include at least one example dated within the past year.
- ☐ Regulatory references must be version-controlled and up-to-date as per active project requirements.
- ☐ Retention of risk/party records as per applicable national (UK) legal requirements or contract terms.

### **PREPARATION ROADMAP**

- ☐ Confirm risk register and interested parties matrix are populated and up to date with ownership, mitigation, and recent review documented.
- ☐ Assemble regulatory documents (BS 7671, CDM guidance, Gas Safe certificates) for auditor reference.
- ☐ Prepare samples of toolbox talk records and onboarding/training session notes demonstrating active knowledge transfer.
- ☐ Schedule a management review of context, risks, and opportunities prior to Stage 2 if not already completed within the year.

# Leadership

## AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Show how Gareth Pryce, as Managing Director, demonstrates direct leadership and commits to reviewing quality objectives, especially in the annual planning meetings.
- ☐ Provide examples of how the quality policy is communicated to site staff, including Site Manager Lee Hammond and the operatives, prior to mobilisation.
- ☐ How are responsibilities for achieving quality objectives (such as meeting programme dates or reducing snags) assigned and documented at Example Ltd?
- ☐ What escalation procedure do you follow if key objectives or client expectations are not being met — for example, if completed jobs fall below the 95% on-time target?

## EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Signed or dated quality policy and minutes or records from annual planning/management review meetings, showing Gareth Pryce's involvement.
- ☐ Quality objectives document with named owners (e.g. Lee Hammond for snag reduction, Joanne Clarke for documentation completion) and defined targets (such as “snags at handover: ≤10/job by end 2026”).
- ☐ Toolbox talk records or pre-mobilisation briefing notes illustrating communication of quality expectations to teams.
- ☐ Flowcharts, organisation charts, or written procedures showing escalation routes for nonconformities and programme issues (e.g. reporting up to Gareth Pryce).

## TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Quality policy and objectives review: typically annual, with records from the latest (within 12 months) expected.
- ☐ Briefing notes/toolbox talks for new projects or operatives should be available for the previous few projects (preferably including current site).
- ☐ Nonconformance/escalation logs: as issues arise, reviewable for at least the last 3 months; retention as per UK/contractual requirements.

## **PREPARATION ROADMAP**

- ☐ Ensure all team members are briefed on the quality policy and objectives, especially before mobilisation on new projects.
- ☐ Collate recent management review notes highlighting leadership actions and responsibilities (with Gareth Pryce's signature or initials if feasible).
- ☐ Review escalation routes for complaints and delayed programme items, ensuring records show clear communication and ownership.
- ☐ Prepare select examples where key objectives (like documentation completion or on-time delivery) have been monitored and followed up by management.

# Planning, Support & Operation

## AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Present actual data showing how you monitor your three key objectives: jobs completed to agreed programme date, number of snagging items at handover, and completeness of commissioning/test packs.
- ☐ Provide evidence of the staged checks (first-fix, second-fix, final-fix) carried out by Lee Hammond and how sign-off is documented before progressing to the next stage.
- ☐ How does Joanne Clarke control project documentation versions (drawings, RAMS, test certificates) to avoid the use of outdated documents on live sites?
- ☐ Describe the process from procurement to delivery – how are deliveries checked, and any shortfalls or errors promptly escalated for corrective action?
- ☐ How is calibration and CSCS/ECS/gas ticket renewal tracked for tools and operatives managed by Ricky Obeng?

## EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Monthly or project KPI tracking logs for programme adherence, snag-counts per handover, and documentation completion rates.
- ☐ Staged inspection records showing Lee Hammond's sign-off at first, second and final-fix stages, plus final snagging checklists (may include Appendix A template).
- ☐ Version tracking/issue log of controlled documents managed by Joanne Clarke – including marking of superseded documents and maintaining access controls.
- ☐ Sample procurement records: materials schedule, purchase orders, delivery notes, and issue reporting showing prompt resolution of supplier issues.
- ☐ Master register of calibration certificates for plant/test equipment and training/ticket renewal log for all operatives, showing scheduled checks by Ricky Obeng.

### **TIMING & FREQUENCY**

- ☐ KPI data and snag logs: must cover at least the preceding 3 months to show this is “lived”, not just a policy.
- ☐ Documentation control: logs and registers must reflect current, live operations and show historic versioning for at least the last active project.
- ☐ Calibration and ticket records: all items/tickets must be in date at the time of audit; renewal evidence should go back 12 months.
- ☐ Issue logs and procurement documentation: retain as per UK statutory and contract retention periods.

### **PREPARATION ROADMAP**

- ☐ Begin tracking key KPIs, snags, and documentation completion at least 3 months prior to the Stage 2 audit; collate logs and ensure they are up to date.
- ☐ Prepare a sample set of completed inspection checklists, a recent snag log, and example project documentation files for auditor review.
- ☐ Verify calibration/test certificate register and operative ticket log are current and free of expired entries; flag any due for renewal.
- ☐ Ensure delivery and procurement processes, including issue escalation and supplier reviews, can be evidenced by recent emails, logs, or meeting notes.



# Performance Evaluation & Improvement

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## AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Show your internal audit schedule and logs. Who audited which processes and how were findings, such as incomplete commissioning records, followed up?
- ☐ Produce your latest management review record, including how performance against objectives and trends in nonconformities were discussed and actions assigned.
- ☐ Provide examples of completed corrective action logs for recurring issues (such as repeat snag types, late supplier deliveries, or expired calibration/tickets) – how was effectiveness checked?
- ☐ How is supplier performance reviewed and what changes are made if suppliers repeatedly cause programme delays?

## EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Internal audit plan(s) and reports (e.g. audit log showing scope, date, process owner, findings, and actions) — with evidence that audits are performed by someone not directly involved in the area being audited.
- ☐ Minutes or notes from management reviews led by Gareth Pryce, showing discussion of KPIs, corrective actions, resource allocation, and client feedback.
- ☐ Completed corrective action logs, showing how issues were analysed, actions assigned (including to Lee Hammond, Joanne Clarke, or Ricky Obeng), and status verified as implemented.
- ☐ Supplier review records (formal or informal) and logs showing any changes in approved supplier status, and documented rationale for “move business elsewhere” if necessary.

### **TIMING & FREQUENCY**

- ☐ Internal audits: at least annually; all process areas should be covered within each 12-month cycle.
- ☐ Management reviews: held at planned intervals (typically annually), with the latest review available for inspection (within past 12 months).
- ☐ Corrective action and supplier review logs: current and must show records for ongoing or recent issues in this and the previous year.
- ☐ Retention periods for these records: as per UK legal/statutory and contractual requirements.

### **PREPARATION ROADMAP**

- ☐ Conduct at least one complete internal audit before Stage 2, ensuring it covers all main process areas and results are actioned.
- ☐ Complete a formal management review based on actual KPI data, audit findings, nonconformance log, and recent supplier performance.
- ☐ Close-out and document all open corrective actions, with evidence of follow-through and review of effectiveness.
- ☐ Ensure supplier evaluation results are available for the previous year and that any changes are justified and documented.

# Improvement

## AUDITOR QUESTIONS

- ☐ Give recent examples where issues such as a repeat materials delivery problem or a recurring snag have led to changes in your procedures or staff training.
- ☐ How do you ensure lessons learned from audits, complaints or client feedback are shared beyond the immediate job team, and reflected in revised work instructions or toolbox talks?
- ☐ How is the effectiveness of improvement actions verified (for example, demonstrating that improved pre-handover checks have reduced snags at handover)?

### EVIDENCE REQUIRED

- ☐ Corrective action records and logs showing how process or training changes were implemented and communicated.
- ☐ Toolbox talk or meeting notes evidencing sharing of lessons learned and updates to work instructions.
- ☐ Before-and-after trend data (for example, snag count reduction or closure rate improvement) linked to the improvement action taken.

### TIMING & FREQUENCY

- ☐ Improvement logs and action records must be current and include at least one example from the past year.
- ☐ Toolbox talk, work instruction and lessons-learned documentation: updated as improvements are implemented, evidence from previous project(s) expected.
- ☐ Trend data monitoring effectiveness: show outcome tracked for at least 3 months after change.

## PREPARATION ROADMAP

- ☐ Identify and document recent improvements made (e.g. to procurement, snag management, or document control) including root-cause analysis and assigned actions.
- ☐ Prepare meeting notes and updated work instructions that show these improvements have been communicated to all relevant staff.

- ☐ Provide demonstration data (KPI trends, snag rates, closure logs) showing the effect of improvements implemented within the past year.

*For all "live" evidence (logs, registers, action records), auditors favour material that predates the audit by at least 2–3 months, as this shows the QMS is being operated in real conditions — not only prepared immediately prior to the audit.*